Measure and Integration Theory

K. Höflinger

This text serves as a comprised review on the essentials of *measure and integration theory*, a fundamental area in modern mathematics with many applications to functional and harmonic analysis and other fields of importance. The content is presented within three parts: the first one describes abstract measure spaces and different kinds of measures, the second one deals with Lebesgue's integration theory and the final one considers measures on locally compact topological spaces.

I. Measure Spaces

In mathematics a *measure* is a way of assigning a numerical value to certain subsets of a given base set, which can be considered as the length, the area or the volume of such sets. One may think of the situation in the real line, where each compact interval $[a, b]$ is measured by the real number $b-a$. This mapping can easily be extended to finite or actually countable many unions of finite intervals under the assumption that the involved intervals are pairwise disjoint.

1. Measurable Spaces. Motivated by the introductory statements, we are interested in collections of subsets of a set X, which are closed under taking countable unions, and each member of such a collection will be called a *measurable set*. This means that the collection of measurable sets will be the natural domain for a measure.

For a non-empty set X, the domain of a measure on X is a collection of subsets of X, called a *σ-algebra*. In particular, a σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}$ on X is defined by the following properties:

1. $\mathcal{B}$ contains the empty set $\emptyset$.
2. $\mathcal{B}$ is closed under complemention: if $A, B \in \mathcal{B}$, then $A \setminus B \in \mathcal{B}$ (this property implies $X \in \mathcal{B}$).
3. $\mathcal{B}$ is closed under taking countable unions, that is, if $\{A_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a sequence of sets $A_n \in \mathcal{B}$, then $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n \in \mathcal{B}$.

From de Morgan's law (which is just as valid for infinite unions and intersections as it is for finite ones), one can see that σ-algebras

Latest version: 14th November 2026.

Email: *khoeflinger@t-online.de*, Url: https://khoefli.github.io/khMath.

are also closed under countable intersections. We call an element of a σ-algebra a *measurable set*, and each pair $(X, \mathcal{B})$ consisting of a set X and a σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}$ is said to be a *measurable space*.

2. Generators of σ-Algebras. We now describe two methods, how σ-algebras can be established supposed a base set X is given.

First, we may claim that the intersection of arbitrarily many σ-algebras forms a σ-algebra again. Thus, for a given collection $\mathcal{A}$ of subsets of the set X (think of the collection of finite intervals in $\mathbb{R}$ for instance), we define the coarsest σ-algebra containing $\mathcal{A}$ (denoted $[\mathcal{A}]$). This resulting σ-algebra $[\mathcal{A}]$ is called *generated* by $\mathcal{A}$, and $\mathcal{A}$ is said to be a *generator* of $[\mathcal{A}]$.

Second, if X' is a subset of X and $\mathcal{B}$ is a σ-algebra on X, it is possible to define the *subset-σ-algebra* on X' as the collection of all intersections $X' \cap B$ with $B \in \mathcal{B}$.

Using the first method described above, we define the *Borel* σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R})$ on the real line $\mathbb{R}$ to be the σ-algebra generated by the collection of closed and finite intervals $[a, b] \subset \mathbb{R}$. Each element of $\mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R})$ is called a *Borel-measurable set*. Similarly, for the higher dimensional Euclidean spaces the Borel σ-algebras $\mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ are generated by the collection of open subsets, closed subsets, compact subsets and open balls in $\mathbb{R}^n$. Applying the second method for any subset $X \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, we can define the σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}(X)$, which is also called the Borel σ-algebra on X.

3. Positive Measures. Given any collection of measurable sets, a measure is nothing but a *set function* acting additively on sequences of pairwise disjoint measurable sets.

Let $(X, \mathcal{B})$ a measurable space. Then a *measure* is a mapping $\mu : \mathcal{B} \to \mathbb{R}^+ \cup \{\infty\}$ satisfying (1) $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$ and (2) the main condition

$$\mu\Big(\bigsqcup_{i=1}^{\infty} M_i\Big) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \mu(M_i)$$

for any sequence of pairwise disjoint sets $\{M_1, M_2, M_3, \ldots\} \subset \mathcal{B}$, which is the fundamental property of a measure denoted *countable additivity* or *σ-additivity*.

Since a measure μ takes values in the interval $[0, \infty]$, it is often called an *unsigned* or a *positive* measure (in distinction to other concepts like *signed* and *complex* measures which are discussed below).

Each triple $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ consisting of a measurable space and a measure μ on X is called a *measure space*. It is a central concept in measure theory,

Given a measure μ, the inclusion $A \subset B$ implies $\mu(A) \leq \mu(B)$ for any measurable sets A, B. This property of a measure is called *monotonicity*. But there are further properties which measures may or may not have:

1. If $\mu(A) < \infty$ for each set $A \in \mathcal{B}$, then μ is called a *finite* measure. The measure μ is called σ-finite, if there is a sequence A_n of measurable sets such that
$$X = \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n, \quad A_n \subset A_{n+1}, \quad \mu(A_n) < \infty \text{ for all } n \in \mathbb{N}.$$
2. A measure μ is said to be *concentrated* on a measurable set A, if $\mu(E) = 0$ for all sets $E \in \mathcal{B}$ which are distinct from A. This is equivalent to the statement that $\mu(E) = \mu(A \cap E)$ for every $E \in \mathcal{B}$.
3. For two measures μ, ν on $\mathcal{B}$ suppose there exist disjoint sets A_μ, A_ν such that μ is concentrated on A_μ and ν is concentrated on A_ν. Then μ, ν are called *mutually singular* denoted $\mu \perp \nu$.

Finally, a property E defined for elements $x \in X$ is called *μ-almost everywhere valid*, if the set of all elements x, for which $E(x)$ does *not* hold, is a null set or the subset of a null set.

4. Signed Measures. There are several possibilities to extend the notion of a (positive) measure. One of them is that of a *signed measure*, which is characterized by the property to take values in the extended real lines $(-\infty, \infty] := \mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\}$ or $[-\infty, \infty) := \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty\}$. In particular, for a measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ a set function
$$\mu : \mathcal{B} \to (-\infty, +\infty] \quad \text{or} \quad \mu : \mathcal{B} \to [-\infty, +\infty)$$
is called a *signed measure*, if $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$ and μ is countable additive. A signed measure is called *finite*, if it takes values in the real line only.

Each positive measure can be regarded as a special case of a signed measure. In fact, if μ, ν are positive measures, one can take the difference $\mu - \nu$ to obtain a signed measure under the assumption that one of them is finite.

Conversely, for signed measures the HAHN-JORDAN *decomposition theorem* holds, quoting that each signed measure can be represented as the difference of two positive measures:

THEOREM 4.1. For each signed measure μ on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ there are two positive measures μ_+ and μ_-, such that for every set $A \in \mathcal{B}$ the equality $\mu(A) = \mu_+(A) - \mu_-(A)$ holds.

In addition, there is a disjoint decomposition of the base set X into sets P and N such that μ_+ is the zero measure on N and μ_- is the zero measure on P. If $X = P' \sqcup N'$ is a further decomposition having these properties, then the sets P, P' and N, N' differ only in null sets with respect to μ.

The sum of two finite signed measures is a finite signed measure as well as the product of a finite signed measure by a real number. Hence finite signed measures are closed under linear combinations of them, which implies that the set $\mathcal{M}^-(X, \mathcal{B})$ of finite signed measures on a measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ is a real linear space. Given a signed measure μ, the measure $|\mu| := \mu_+ + \mu_-$ is called the *total variation* of μ, which in case of $|\mu| < \infty$ is called of *bounded variation.*

5. Complex Measures. In contrast to positive and signed measures, a *complex measure* on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ is a σ-additive set function $\mu : \mathcal{B} \to \mathbb{C}$. and the condition $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$ is fulfilled by itself, so it need not be part of the definition of this notation.

When dealing with complex measures, it is possible to define the concept of *variation.* More precisely, the variation $|\mu|$ of a complex measure μ is that mapping $|\mu| : \mathcal{B} \to [0, \infty]$, which assigns to each measurable set A the value

$$|\mu|(A) := \sup \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \|\mu(A_n)\|,$$

where the sequences (A_n) may be any mostly countable disjoint decompositions of A in measurable subsets. It is a surprising result that for each complex measure μ the variation $|\mu|$ is actually a *finite* positive measure.

The *total variation* of a complex measure μ is defined to be the variation of the entire set X, that is, $|\mu| := |\mu|(X)$. Since $|\mu| < \infty$, each complex measure proves to be of *bounded variation.*

6. Measurable Functions. The main thing what one can do with a measure is to integrate real-valued or complex-valued functions. But in general this is not possible for arbitrary functions, that is, the restriction to the so-called *measurable functions* is required. By this way we will establish the *Lebesgue integral* for measurable functions,

which may or may not exist for such a function. It turns out that the Lebesuge integral has much better behaviour with respect to certain limit processes than the classical Riemann integral, which suffers from the drawback that the limit function of a sequence of Riemann-integrable functions need not be Riemann-integrable again.

The notion of measurability of a function is elementary in integration theory. Let $(X, \mathcal{B})$ and $(X', \mathcal{B}')$ be measurable spaces, then any mapping $f : X \to X'$ is called *measurable*, if $f^{-1}(A) \in \mathcal{B}$ for every set $A \in \mathcal{B}'$. Note that this definition is rather similar to that of continuity for functions between topological spaces.

The measurablility of a given function f is ensured, if the pre-images of those subsets in X' are measurable in X, which form a generator of the σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}'$. Especially in case of a measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ and a real-valued function $f : X \to \mathbb{R}$, the function f is measurable with respect to the σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R})$, if and only if the pre-images of the half-bounded intervals $A_\lambda := \{ x \in \mathbb{R} : x \leq \lambda \}$ are elements of $\mathcal{B}$, and in this case the mapping f is called a *Borel function*.

If f, g are Borel functions and λ is a real number, then $f + g$ and λf are Borel functions again, so the set of Borel functions for a given measurable space forms a linear space. It is also important to know that f is measurable, iff the functions f^+ and f^- are both measurable, which are defined to be the positive and negative part of the real-valued function f, that is, $f = f^+ - f^-$. We conclude that the modulus function $|f| := f^+ + f^-$ is measurable, supposed the function f is so.

In case of complex-valued functions, a function $f : X \to \mathbb{C}$ is said to be measurable, iff both the real and imaginary part of f are measurable.

II. Lebesgue Integration

Integration is a way of assigning a mean value to a given function. The basic idea of *Lebesgue integration* is to decomposite the range of a function $f : X \to \mathbb{R}$ into intervals and to measure the pre-images of them. If these pre-images are measurable sets with respect to a measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$, we can do a first step to assign a real number to f, which may be regarded as the integral of f.

1. Setup of the Lebesgue Integral. Usually the definition of the Lebesgue integral is carried out in four steps, beginning with that for elementary functions. Let $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ be a measure space. Our aim is to define Lebesgue-integration for every measurable function, which will be done by a couple of steps:

1. A mapping $\chi_A : X \to \mathbb{R}$ is called the *characteristic function* of a measurable set A, if $\chi(x) = 1$ for $x \in A$ and $\chi(x) = 0$ otherwise. We can simply define the Lebesgue-Integral of χ_A by
$$\int_X \chi_A \, d\mu := \mu(A),$$
and the function χ_A is called *Lebesgue-integrable*, iff $\mu(A) < \infty$.
2. A measurable function $e : X \to \mathbb{R}$ is called *simple*, if there are finitely many real numbers $a_1, \ldots, a_n$ such that $e(x) \in \{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$ for all $x \in \mathbb{R}$, that is, the range of a simple function is a finite set. Equivalently, a simple function e is a linear combination of characteristic functions, and we define the Lebesgue integral for e by the setting
$$\int_X e \, d\mu := \sum_{i=1}^{m} a_i \cdot \int_X \chi_{A_i} \, d\mu.$$
If this is a finite value, then the simple function e is said to be *Lebesgue-integrable.*
3. Now, let the function $f : X \to \mathbb{R}$ be nonnegative and measurable. In this case we define the set $\mathcal{E}_f$ as the collection of all simple functions e satisfying the property $e(x) \leq f(x)$ for all $x \in X$. Note that the set $\mathcal{E}_f$ is non-empty, since for each measurable function f there is a sequence $\{e_n\}$ of simple functions with $e_1 \leq e_2 \leq e_3 \leq \ldots$ and $\lim_{n\to\infty} e_n = f$ pointwise. We define the *Lebesgue integral* of f as follows:
$$\int_X f \, d\mu := \sup_{e \in \mathcal{E}_f} \int_X e \, d\mu.$$
If the supremum is a finite number, the nonnegative and measurable function f is called *Lebesgue-integrable.*
4. In order to define the Lebesgue integral of a measurable function $g : X \to \mathbb{R}$, let us decomposite g into the difference of nonnegative measurable functions f^+, f^-, i.e. $g := f^+ - f^-$, reducing the concept of integration for g to that of the functions f^+ and f^-.

Then the function g is said to be *Lebesgue-integrable*, if f^+ and f^- are both Lebesgue-integrable, and the Lebesgue integral of g is defined according to

$$\int_X g\,d\mu := \int_X f^+\,d\mu - \int_X f^-\,d\mu,$$

It turns out that a measurable function g is Lebesgue-integrable, if and only if the function $|g| := f^+ + f^-$ is Lebesgue-integrable, and in this case the function f is said to be *absolutely integrable*.

The construction of the Lebesgue integral is done now. Lebesgue integration enjoys a list of nice properties:

1. If $A \subset X$ is a null set, the Lebesgue integral has the value 0 for any measurable function.
2. If two functions f, g are Lebesgue-integrable, then any linear combination $\alpha f + \beta g$ with $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$ is Lebesgue-integrable, too, and the equation

$$\int_X (\alpha f + \beta g)\,d\mu = \alpha \int_X f\,d\mu + \beta \int_X g\,d\mu$$

holds. Thus the mapping $f \mapsto \int_X f\,d\mu$ is a linear map. More precisely, it is a linear functional on the $\mathbb{R}$-linear space of Lebesgue-integrable functions.
3. For a Lebesgue-integrable function the following inequality holds:

$$\left|\int_X f\,d\mu\right| \leq \int_X |f|\,d\mu$$

4. If $f \leq g$ μ-almost everywhere, then

$$\int_X f\,d\mu \leq \int_X g\,d\mu,$$

Extensions of the Lebesgue integral are possible to (1) complex-valued measurable functions and (2) measurable subsets of the base space X. Firstly, for the class of complex-valued functions we define f to be Lebesgue-integrable, iff real and imaginary part of f are so, and in this case the Lebesgue integral is

$$\int_X f\,d\mu := \int_X \operatorname{Re} f\,d\mu + i \cdot \int_X \operatorname{Im} f\,d\mu.$$

The mapping $f \mapsto \int f d\mu$ is $\mathbb{C}$-linear on the linear space of Lebesgue-integrable complex-valued functions. Like in the case of real-valued functions, a Lebesgue-integrable complex-valued function satisfies

the inequality

$$|\int_X f\,d\mu| \le \int_X |f|\,d\mu.$$

Second, if $A \in \mathcal{B}$ is measurable, then

$$\int_A f\,d\mu := \int_X f\cdot\chi_A\,d\mu.$$

For a fixed measure space $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$, one can construct a lot of further measures using Lebesgue integration by the setting

$$\mu_f(A) := \int_X f\cdot\chi_A\,d\mu, \quad A \in \mathcal{B},$$

where $f : X \to [0, \infty]$ is any nonnegative measurable function. If g is another function fullfilling these properties, the formula

$$\int_X g\,d\mu_f = \int_X g \cdot f\,d\mu$$

holds, and if μ is σ-finite, the identity $\mu_f = \mu_g$ is valid, if and only if $f = g$ μ-nearly everywhere. Thus a function $f : X \to [0, \infty]$ (modulo μ-almost everywhere equivalence) can be identified with a positive measure μ_f on X.

2. Convergence Theorems. One of the main purposes of the Lebesgue integral is, in contrary to the classical Riemann integral, that under some restrictions we can swap the limit process of a pointwise convergent sequence of functions with integration in the sense that

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \int_X f_n\,d\mu = \int_X \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n\,d\mu.$$

There are some cases in which this exchange can be done without doubt, and we will mention two theorems which describe such a desirable situation.

The first one, due to B. LEVI, is called the *monotone convergence theorem* and states as follows:

THEOREM 2.1. Let the real-valued functions $\{f_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ be nonnegative, Lebesgue-integrable and monotone increasing, i.e.

$$f_i(x) \le f_j(x) \text{ for all } x \in X, \quad i < j.$$

Then there is a Lebesgue-integrable function f having the property that $f = \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n$ μ-almost-everywhere and

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \int_X f_n \, d\mu = \int_X \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n \, d\mu.$$

Thus the process of limitation does not exceed the class of Lebesgue-integrable functions. In this sense the set of Lebesgue-integrable functions is closed.

The second theorem, called the *dominated convergence theorem* due to H. LEBESGUE, yields a sufficient criterion for integrability of a function, which is defined by the limit process of a sequence of integrable functions:

THEOREM 2.2. Suppose that the sequence (f_n) of Lebesgue-integrable functions $f_n : X \to \mathbb{R}$ has the property

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} f_n = f \quad \mu\text{-almost everywhere.}$$

In addition, if there is a Lebesgue-integrable function g with $|f_n| \leq g$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, then f is Lebesgue-integrable, too, and integration can be commuted with the process of limitation, that is

$$\int_X f \, d\mu = \lim_{n\to\infty} \int_X f_n \, d\mu.$$

3. Product Spaces. The method of constructing a σ-algebra by given subsets of a base set can be used to define a σ-algebra over the cartesian product of measurable spaces.

Let $(X_1, \mathcal{B}_1)$ and $(X_2, \mathcal{B}_2)$ be measurable spaces. Then for the cartesian product $X_1 \times X_2$ there is a σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}_1 \times \mathcal{B}_2$ called the *product σ-algebra*, which is generated by all sets $A_1 \times A_2$ with $A_1 \in \mathcal{B}_1, A_2 \in \mathcal{B}_2$. It is the smallest σ-algebra over $X_1 \times X_2$, such that the projection mappings $(x_1, x_2) \mapsto x_1$ and $(x_1, x_2) \mapsto x_2$ are still measurable. This construction can be extended to a finite number of products of measurable spaces.

If μ_1, μ_2 are measures on the measurable spaces $(X_1, \mathcal{B}_1)$ and $(X_2, \mathcal{B}_2)$, then there is a measure $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ on the σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}_1 \times \mathcal{B}_2$, such that for all measurable sets $A_1 \in \mathcal{B}_1$, $A_2 \in \mathcal{B}_2$:

$$\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2(A_1, A_2) = \mu_1(A_1) \cdot \mu_2(A_2)$$

The measure $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ obtained this way is called the *product measure* on the measurable space $(X_1 \times X_2, \mathcal{B}_1 \times \mathcal{B}_2)$. If both measures μ_1, μ_2 are σ-finite, then $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ is unique and σ-finite, too.

Under certain conditions the Lebesgue integral for any measurable function $f : X_1 \otimes X_2 \to \mathbb{R}$ with respect to the product measure $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ can be reduced to the Lebesgue integrals of the single measures. This is the assertion of the FUBINI-TONELLI *theorem*:

THEOREM 3.1. Let $f : X_1 \times X_2 \to \mathbb{R}$ be $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$-integrable. Then the following holds:

1. the function $f_y(x) := f(x, y)$ is μ_1-almost-everywhere integrable,
2. the function $f_x(y) := f(x, y)$ is μ_2-almost-everywhere integrable,
3. the order of integration can be commuted, that is, if

$$M_1(x) := \int_{X_2} f_x(y)\, d\mu_2, \qquad M_2(y) := \int_{X_1} f_y(x)\, d\mu_1,$$

then the following identities hold:

$$\int_{X_1 \times X_2} f(x, y)\, d(\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2) = \int_{X_1} M_1(x)\, d\mu_1 = \int_{X_2} M_2(y)\, d\mu_2.$$

4. Absolutely Continuous Measures. The concept of an *absolutely continuous measure* is of fundamental meaning in measure theory. Let $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ be a measure space and ν a further measure define on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$. Then ν is called *absolutely continuous* with respect to μ (notation: $\nu \ll \mu$), if each μ-null set is always a ν-null set, that is, $\mu(A) = 0$ implies $\nu(A) = 0$ for each measurable set A.

Two measures are said to be equivalent, if each is absolutely continuous with respect to the other one. Hence we can divide all the measures defined on a measurable space into equivalence classes and denote each of them a *measure class*.

Given any positive measure μ, the related absolutely continuous measures with respect to μ can easily be found. If $f : X \to [0, \infty)$ is a Lebesgue integrable function, then f causes by means of the mapping

$$\nu_f(A) = \int_A f\, d\mu, \quad A \in \mathcal{B}$$

an absolutely continuous measure ν_f with respect to μ. Thus Lebesgue integrable functions can be regardes as absolutely continuous measures on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$. On the other side, the *Radon-Nikodym theorem* states that the measure ν_f are the only absolutely continuous measures with respect to μ:

THEOREM 4.1. Let μ be a σ-finite measure on $(X, \mathcal{B})$, $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ be a σ-finite measure space and ν a measure being absolutely continuous with respect to μ. Then there exists a Lebesgue-integrable map $f_\nu : X \to [0, \infty)$ such that

$$\nu(A) = \int_X f_\nu \, d\mu \quad \text{for all } A \in \mathcal{B}.$$

The condition of μ being σ-finite is essential. The function f_ν is called the *Radon-Nikodym derivation* of ν with respect to μ and is uniquely defined μ-mostly everywhere.

The Radon-Nikodym theorem can also be stated for a complex measure ν, but one has to use the variation $|\nu|$ in this case, which is known to be a positive finite measure. A complex measure ν is called *absolutely continuous* with respect to the positive measure μ, if $|\nu| \ll \mu$. Then a further variant of the Radon-Nikodym theorem reads as follows:

THEOREM 4.2. Let μ be a σ-finite positive measure on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ and ν be a complex measure satisfying $\nu \ll \mu$. Then there is $f \in L^1(X; \mathbb{C})$ such that

$$\nu(A) = \int_X f \, d\mu \quad \text{for all } A \in \mathcal{B}.$$

We will finish the considerations about absolutely continuous measures with the LEBESGUE *decomposition theorem.* It asserts that for a given σ-finite measure space $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ each complex measure ν can be represented as the sum of an absolutely continuous measure ν_c and a singular measure ν_s, both with respect to μ:

THEOREM 4.3. Let μ be a positive σ-finite measure and ν a complex measure on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$. Then there is a uniquely defined pair (ν_c, ν_s) of complex measures such that

$$\nu = \nu_c + \nu_s, \quad \nu_c \ll \mu, \quad \nu_s \perp \mu.$$

If the measure ν is positive, then both measures ν_c and ν_s are positive, too.

III. Measures on Locally Compact Spaces

Abstract Measure theory also includes the study of measures on topological spaces. But these spaces must be assumend to be *locally*

compact in order to obtain a satisfactory theory.

Recall that the σ-algebra $[\mathcal{F}]$, generated by a family of subsets $\mathcal{F} \subset 2^X$ of a base set X, can be received as the intersection of all σ-algebras containing this family $\mathcal{F}$. If $(X, \mathcal{T})$ is a topological space, the σ-algebra $[\mathcal{T}]$ generated by the family $\mathcal{T}$ of open sets is called the *Borel σ-algebra* of X. It is also generated by the family of closed sets of X. Each set $B \in [\mathcal{T}]$ is called *Borel-measurable* or a *Borel set*. Moreover, if X is Hausdorff and can be represented as a union of mostly countable compact sets, then $[\mathcal{T}]$ is also generated by the family of compact subsets of X.

The (topological) *support* of a measure μ on a topological space X is a notion of where in the space X the measure *lives*. It is defined to be the largest closed subset $\operatorname{supp}(\mu)$ of X, for which every open neighbourhood of any point x of $\operatorname{supp}(\mu)$ has positive measure. A measure μ is called *discrete*, if $\operatorname{supp}(\mu)$ consists of a mostly countable set of points, i.e. if μ is concentrated to a sequence of single points of the space X.

Remember also that bounded subsets of the Euclidean spaces $\mathbb{R}^d$ have a finite measure. This property can be extended to topological spaces by the request, that a measure should adopt finite values for compact sets. Consequently we define a measure with this property as follows: let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space and $[\mathcal{T}]$ its Borel σ-algebra. Then any measure μ is called a *Borel measure* for X, if $\mu(K) < \infty$ for every compact set $K \in [\mathcal{T}]$. For example, the counting measure is a Borel measure on the set of integers with respect to the discrete topology. In addition, a measure μ on the Borel sets of X is called *locally finite*, if for each point $x \in X$ there is an open neighbourhood $\mathcal{O}_x$ such that $\mu(\mathcal{O}_x) < \infty$.

Each local finite measure is a Borel measure. But if the topological space X is a locally compact Hausdorff space, then the inverse statement is also true, that is, each locally finite measure is a Borel measure.

1. Regularity of Measures. Let X be a topological space and μ be a positive measure on its Borel σ-algebra. Then a Borel set $B \subseteq X$ is called *inner regular* with respect to μ, if

$$\mu(B) = \sup\{\, \mu(K) : K \subset B,\ K \text{ compact} \,\}.$$

A measure μ is called *inner regular*, if all Borel sets are inner regular. Thus the inner regular measures on X are already defined by its

values for compact subsets. Each locally finite and inner regular measure on a topological space X is called a *Radon measure.*

On the other hand, a measure μ on a topological space X is called *outer regular*, if for each Borel set $B \subseteq X$ the equality

$$\mu(B) = \inf\{\mu(\mathcal{O}) : B \subset \mathcal{O}, \mathcal{O} \text{ open}\}$$

holds. A measure is called *regular*, if it is outer and inner regular. For any finite and regular measure μ, for each Borel set $B \subset X$ and for each $\epsilon > 0$ there is a compact set K_ϵ and an open set $\mathcal{O}_\epsilon$ such that

$$K_\epsilon \subset B \subset \mathcal{O}_\epsilon \text{ and } \mu(\mathcal{O}_\epsilon \setminus K_\epsilon) < \epsilon.$$

In other words, for a Borel set B the value $\mu(B)$ of such a measure μ can be approximated by its values for compact subsets and open supersets of B.

There are a couple of sufficient conditions on the topology in X, which ensure that Borel measures are regular. For example, this is true if either X is a compact metric space satisfying the *first countability axiom* or X is a *polish space*, that is, X is metrizable, separable and complete (this is the assertion of ULAM*'s theorem*). If X is a finite interval $[a, b]$, this theorem implies that every Borel measure on $[a, b]$ is Radon.

The meaning of regular measures primarily relies on the fact that so-called *density theorems* can be quoted. They ensure the possibility to approximate Lebesgue-integrable functions by continuous ones.

2. Haar Measures. The existence of a translation invariant measure on a certain class of groups is one of the highlights in abstract measure theory and forms the foundation of a further mathematical area called *abstract harmonic analysis.*

Remember that a topological group is an algebraic one together with a topology $\mathcal{T}$, such that the group operations are continuous mappings. A measure μ defined on the Borel sets of a topological group G is called *left invariant* respectively *right invariant*, if for each element $g \in G$ and each Borel set $B \in \mathcal{B}(G)$ we have

$$\mu(B) = \mu(g \circ B) \quad \text{rsp.} \quad \mu(B) = \mu(B \circ g).$$

In addition, a measure is called *invariant*, if it is left *and* right invariant. Note that if G is an Abelian group, the notions of left and right invariance of a measure fall together.

Let G be a locally compact Hausdorff space and a topological group together. Then there is a left invariant positive Radon measure $\mu : \mathcal{B}(G) \to [0, \infty]$, which is unique up to a constant $c > 0$. This measure is called a *Haar measure* on G.

The following important examples of Haar measures are known:

1. For the topological groups $(\mathbb{R}^d, +)$ the Haar measure is called the *Lebesgue-Borel measure* λ^n.
2. For the complex unit circle $\mathbb{T} \subset \mathbb{C}$ the mapping

$$\phi(f) := \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} f(e^{it})\, dt, \quad f \in C(\mathbb{C}^\times, \mathbb{R})$$

is a nonnegative invariant linear form, and the associated invariant Radon measure is proportional to the Lebesgue-Borel measure on $\mathbb{T}$.

3. The Lebesgue-Borel Measure. There are only few measurable spaces, on which a measure can be defined in a very natural way. An example of such measure spaces is any countable set, whose σ-algebra is defined to be the power set of that space, and a measure deserving the notion *standard measure* for this space is the counting measure $\mu_\#$, that is, the mapping assigning to each subset its cardinal number. In particular, for the set of integers we get the measure space $(\mathbb{Z}, 2^{\mathbb{Z}}, \mu_\#)$ this way.

Concerning the Euclidean spaces $\mathbb{R}^d$, the situation is not quite so simple. Here only those measures come into consideration, which provide for such elementary sets like intervals, rectangles or d-dimensional cubes the associated lengths, areas or volumes. The question arises whether a positive measure exists on the Borel σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}_{\mathbb{R}^d}$ satisfying these properties.

There is a fundamental theorem in measure theory, known as the *measure extension theorem*, which states that in each space $\mathbb{R}^d$ there is exactly one positive measure λ^d, which adopts for each cube $W \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ with border lengths $l_1, \ldots, l_d$ the value

$$\lambda^d(W) = l_1 \cdot l_2 \cdot \ldots \cdot l_{d-1} \cdot l_d,$$

called the *Lebesgue-Borel measure* on the spaces $\mathbb{R}^d$.

It is not surprising that the measure λ^d is the Haar measure for the space $\mathbb{R}^d$. Thus the Lebesgue-Borel measure have the property to be invariant under Euclidean movements, that is, the equation $\lambda^d(B) = \lambda^d(\tau(B))$ holds for each Borel set B and each orthogo-

nal transformation $\tau : \mathbb{R}^d \to \mathbb{R}^d$, in contrary to all other thinkable measures on space $\mathbb{R}^d$.

4. Decomposition of Measures. We turn back to Lebesgue's decomposition theorem, now considered for the measurable space $(\mathbb{R}, \mathcal{B}_\mathbb{R})$ and the Lebesgue-Borel measure λ^1. In it general form it claims that each positive measure ν can be represented in the form

$$\nu = \nu_{ac} + \nu_d + \nu_{cs},$$

$\nu_{ac} \ll \lambda$ being absolutely continuous, ν_d being a measure which is concentrated on a possibly terminating sequence (x_n) of points with $\nu_d(x_n) > 0$, and ν_{cs} being a *continuous singular measure.* A continuous singular measure is characterized by the facts that (1) it is concentrated on a set of measure 0, and (2) it is *atomic* but not absolutely continuous with respect to the measure λ. An example of such a measure is given by the so-called *Cantor distribution.*

To each finite measure μ on $(\mathbb{R}, \mathcal{B}_\mathbb{R})$ the monotonic increasing function

$$F_\mu(a) := \mu(-\infty, a), \quad a \in \mathbb{R}$$

is called the *distribution function* of μ. Now, if $\mu \ll \lambda$ is absolutely continuous, then the associated distribution function is called absolutely continuous, too. In general, each mapping $f : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is called *absolutely continuous*, if there is a locally integrable function $g : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$, such that

$$f(x) := \int_a^x g(t)\, dt, \quad x \in [a, b].$$

An absolutely continuous function has the property to be λ-nearly everywhere differentiable, and the derivative of f is given by the function g. One can characterize absolutely continuous functions as follows: $f : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is *absolutely continuous*, iff for each $\epsilon > 0$ there is a number $\delta > 0$ such that for each decomposition $\mathcal{Z}$ of $[a, b]$ with grid size $F_\mathcal{Z} < \delta$ we have $\sum_i |f(x_{i+1}) - f(x_i)| < \epsilon$. The set of absolutely continuous functions on the interval $[a, b]$ forms a linear space denoted $AC([a, b])$.

5. Comparison of Lebesgue and Riemann Integration. To the end, let us have a look to the question how the Lebesgue integral is comparable with the classical Riemann integral for ordinary functions $f : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$. For this purpose we will review in brief the setup and the basic properties of the Riemannian integral.

To define this concept for a function $f : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$, two auxiliary concepts are required:

1. A *decomposition* P of $[a, b]$ is a sequence of points

$$\{x_0 := a, x_1, \ldots, x_{n-1}, x_n := b\}, \quad x_{i-1} < x_i, \quad i = 1, \ldots, n,$$

and the length $\|P\|$ of the largest subinterval is called the *grid* of P, that is

$$\|P\| := \max_{1 \le i \le n} (x_i - x_{i-1}).$$

2. A *tagged* decomposition $P(t_0, \ldots, t_n)$ of the interval $[a, b]$ is a decomposition P (in the ordinary sense) together with a sequence of points $t_0, \ldots, t_{n-1}$, where each point t_i is contained in the subinterval $[x_i, x_{i+1}]$.

Now, for a tagged decomposition $P(t_0, \ldots, t_n)$ the *Riemannian sum* $R(f, P)$ for the function $f : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is defined by

$$R(f, P) := \sum_{i=1}^{n} f(t_i) \cdot (x_i - x_{i-1}),$$

and the *Riemann integral* of f is received as possible limit value of Riemannian sums $R(f, P)$ by decreasing the grid to zero. The function f is called *Riemann integrable* on $[a, b]$ (briefly *R-integrable*) to the value R_f, if for every $\epsilon > 0$ there is $\delta > 0$ such that

$$|R_f - R(f, P)| < \epsilon$$

for every tagged decomposition $P(t_0, \ldots, t_n)$ with grid $|P| < \delta$, and the magnitude R_f is said to be the *Riemann integral* of f in this case, usually denoted

$$\int_a^b f \, dx := R_f.$$

It is easy to verify that $R(a, b)$, the set of Riemann integrable functions on the interval $[a, b]$, forms a linear space and the Riemann integral constitutes a linear functional $\int_a^b : R(a, b) \to \mathbb{R}$.

Note also that each continuous function, each monotonic function and each function of bounded variation (being the difference of two monotonic increasing functions) is a member of the space $R(a, b)$.

The following theorem goes back to H. Lebesgue and provides a connection between both integration methods for functions defined on a compact interval $[a, b]$:

THEOREM 5.1. Each R-integrable function $f : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is Lebesgue integrable with respect to the Lebesgue-Borel measure $\lambda := \lambda^1$. In addition, for these functions both kinds of integrals coincide, i. e.

$$\int_a^b f(x)\, dx = \int_{[a,b]} f\, d\lambda.$$

Due to this theorem it is possible to compute the Lebesgue integral by applying the known integration rules for Riemann integration like the *product rule*, the *substitution rule* and the *formula of partial integration.*

References.

[1] J. Elstrodt: *Maß -und Integrationstheorie.* Springer Verlag, 2018.